



TOP-Feedback

Installation and Setup Guide

For AFROTC detachment administrators · Alpha 0.4

Before you start

Allow about 45 minutes for a first-time setup using Google Drive. You will need the detachment's Google account credentials and permission to create a Google Cloud project on that account. No servers, databases or software licences are required.

Every procedure in this guide has been performed end to end against real Google Drive, on a Mac and an iPhone. Where something is awkward or unfinished, it is written down rather than smoothed over — see *What this version cannot do yet*.

What this guide covers

TOP-Feedback is a web app that runs in a browser and stores every record in a Google Drive folder your detachment owns. There is no vendor, no server and no shared database — which is why setup involves your own Google account rather than an account with us.

- 1 **Decide where your data will live** — three options, and how to choose
 - 2 **Prepare the Google account** — folder, Cloud project, Drive API, OAuth client
 - 3 **Publish the app** — free hosting, or run it from one computer
 - 4 **Run the setup wizard** — connect the app to your folder
 - 5 **Claim the folder** — the first Google sign-in, and turning off development mode
 - 6 **Build the roster** — instructors and cadets, one at a time or by CSV
 - 7 **Install on phones and laptops** — add to home screen
 - 8 **Verify and hand over** — a checklist before first use
 - **Troubleshooting and reference** — common problems, folder layout, backups
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What you will need

ITEM	WHY
A Google account owned by the detachment	Holds every record. Use a shared unit account, not a personal one.
Permission to create a Google Cloud project	Required once, to let the app talk to that account's Drive.
Somewhere to publish the app	Any static web host. Several free options are listed in Part 3.
A current browser	Chrome, Edge, Safari or Firefox, on any device.

You are not signing up for anything

TOP-Feedback has no accounts with a vendor, no subscription and no data-processing agreement to sign, because no data ever reaches anyone but you. Everything below sets up *your* Google account to hold *your* detachment's feedback.

1 Decide where your data will live

Pick one. You can change later, but moving records between options is a manual export and import, so it is worth choosing correctly now.

OPTION	BEST FOR	WHAT IT MEANS
Google Drive RECOMMENDED	Any detachment with more than one device	Records live in a Drive folder on your Google account. Works on phones, tablets and computers, and everyone sees the same data. Needs the one-time Google setup in Part 2.
Synced folder	A single office computer	Points at the TOP-Feedback folder inside Google Drive for Desktop. Google's own client handles syncing. Desktop Chrome or Edge only — no phones.
This device only	Trying the app out	Everything stays in one browser. Nothing syncs, nothing is shared, and clearing site data erases it. Fine for evaluation — export a backup and import it once you move to Drive.

Why a browser cannot simply be pointed at a Drive folder path

Web pages have no access to the file system, and a phone has no synced Drive folder at all. The Google Drive option therefore connects through Google's own Drive service rather than a folder path. This is the reason Part 2 exists.

If you are evaluating the app, choose *This device only*, skip to Part 4, and come back to Part 2 when you are ready to go live. Nothing is lost — Part 8 explains how to carry your trial data across.

2 Prepare the Google account

Do this once, on the Google account that will own the data. About 20 minutes.

2a. Create the folder

- 1 **Sign in to the detachment's Google account.**
Use a shared unit account. If you use a personal account, the data leaves with the person.
- 2 **Open Google Drive and create a folder named `T0P-Feedback`.**
The name is a convention, not a requirement, but it makes the folder obvious later.
- 3 **Share the folder with the cadre who need access.**
Give *Editor* access to anyone who will use the Instructor Portal.
 - Anyone with access to this folder can read every record directly, including the raw feedback. Share it only with people entitled to see all of it.
- 4 **Copy the folder's web address.**
With the folder open, copy the URL from the browser address bar. It looks like `https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1A2b3C...` — you will paste this in Part 4.

2b. Allow the app to reach that Drive

Google requires any app that touches a Drive account to be registered with that account. This is free and takes about ten minutes.

- 1 **Go to `console.cloud.google.com`**
signed in as the same Google account.
- 2 **Create a new project.**
Name it something recognisable, such as *Det 025 Feedback*. Wait for it to finish creating and make sure it is the selected project in the bar at the top.
- 3 **Enable the Google Drive API.**
 - Navigate to *APIs & Services* → *Library*.
 - Search for **Google Drive API** and open it.
 - Click **Enable**.

- 4 **Configure the OAuth consent screen.**
 - Go to *APIs & Services* → *OAuth consent screen*. Newer consoles file this under *Google Auth Platform* → *Branding*.
 - If your account is on Google Workspace, choose **Internal** — this is simplest and needs no review.
 - If it is a standard Gmail account, choose **External**.
 - Fill in the app name and support email. Nothing else is required.
 - **Leave the publishing status on *Testing***. Do not click *Publish app* — see the warning below.
- 5 **Add every Google account that will use the app under *Test users*.**
 - Cadre, administrators and every *cadet*. An account that is not on this list cannot sign in at all.
 - **The account that owns the project is not automatically a test user**. Add it explicitly, like any other.
 - The limit is 100 accounts, which covers a detachment.
- 6 **Create an OAuth client ID.**
 - Go to *APIs & Services* → *Credentials* → *Create Credentials* → *OAuth client ID*.
 - Application type: **Web application**.
 - Under **Authorised JavaScript origins**, add the exact address the app will be served from — see Part 3 if you do not have it yet. For example `https://det025.github.io`. Include the scheme, exclude any path or trailing slash.
 - Leave *Authorised redirect URIs* empty. The app does not use them.
 - Click **Create** and copy the **Client ID**. It ends in `.apps.googleusercontent.com`.

Do not click "Publish app"

It sounds like the step that makes things work. It is the opposite. TOP-Feedback asks for full Google Drive access, which Google classes as a *restricted* scope: in production that requires completed verification plus a paid third-party security assessment. Publishing without it blocks *everyone*, including you, with "Access blocked ... has not completed the Google verification process" and no way through. If you have already clicked it, open the consent screen and choose **Back to testing**.

Two different "unverified" screens — they mean different things

"Google hasn't verified this app" with an *Advanced* link is normal and expected. Click *Advanced*, then *Go to ... (unsafe)*. Every user sees this, every time, and it cannot be turned off while the app is in Testing.

"Access blocked ... has not completed the Google verification process" with *no* *Advanced* link is a hard refusal. It means either the app was published to production, or that account is not on the test-user list.

Known issue: some accounts cannot be added as test users

Occasionally Google refuses to accept an address on the test-user list, with no useful explanation. This is a Google-side behaviour, not a fault in the app, and there is no published fix. Things that have been worth trying: check whether the account already holds a role under *IAM & Admin* (project members can be rejected as redundant test users); check whether it is enrolled in Google's *Advanced Protection Program*, which bars unverified third-party apps outright; and try adding it from the classic *Credentials* view rather than the newer Google Auth Platform screens, which sometimes fail to save silently.

If an account cannot be added, that person cannot use the app while it is in Testing. Use a different Google account for them.

The Client ID is not a password

It identifies the app to Google and is designed to be public — it is visible in any browser that loads the page. Access is controlled by Google sign-in and by who you shared the folder with, not by keeping this string secret. There is no client *secret* to protect.

If you change where the app is hosted

You must add the new address to **Authorised JavaScript origins** or sign-in will fail with a redirect error. Changes can take a few minutes to take effect.

3 Publish the app

TOP-Feedback is a folder of files with no build step and no backend, so it can be served from anywhere that serves static files.

HTTPS is required

Offline support, installation to a home screen, and Google sign-in all require a secure connection. Every hosting option below provides HTTPS automatically. Opening the files directly from a hard drive will *not* work.

Option A — free static hosting (recommended)

HOST	NOTES
GitHub Pages	Free. Push the folder to a repository and enable Pages in the settings. Address looks like <code>https://yourname.github.io/top-feedback</code> .
Netlify or Cloudflare Pages	Free tier. Drag the folder onto their dashboard — no command line needed.
Your institution's web server	Copy the folder into any directory served over HTTPS.

Option B — run it from one computer

Useful for a trial, or where the detachment cannot publish to the web. Requires Python 3, which is pre-installed on macOS and Linux.

```
cd top-feedback
python3 serve.py          # then open http://localhost:8000

python3 serve.py --https  # needed to reach it from a phone
```

The `--https` option generates a self-signed certificate and prints an address on your local network. Phones will warn that the certificate is untrusted; accept it once. This is fine for testing, but use Option A for real use.

Whichever you choose, note the exact address

You need it for *Authorised JavaScript origins* in Part 2, step 5.

4 Run the setup wizard

If you are signed into more than one Google account, use a clean browser profile

Setup authenticates *twice* — once so the app can reach Drive, once to say who you are — and each time Google shows an account chooser that defaults to whichever account you signed in with first. Picking the wrong one at either prompt produces a half-configured install that fails confusingly later. A clean browser profile, or a private window signed into only the detachment account, removes the choice entirely. If your Drive address bar shows `/u/1/` or higher, you are not on your default account.

Open the app's address in a browser. On a folder that has never been set up, the wizard starts automatically.

1 Name the detachment.

This appears in the app header and on exported reports.

2 Choose your storage option

from Part 1.

3 Connect.

- **Google Drive:** paste the Client ID from Part 2b and the folder link from Part 2a, then click *Sign in and connect*. A Google window opens; sign in as the detachment account and grant access. The wizard confirms the folder name when it succeeds.
- **Synced folder:** click *Select folder...* and choose the TOP-Feedback folder inside your Google Drive for Desktop directory.
- **This device only:** nothing to connect.

4 Create the folders.

The wizard shows exactly what it will create and then builds it. Existing data is never touched, so it is safe to point a second device at the same folder and run the wizard again.

TF

TOP-Feedback

Not configured

● setup

Set up TOP-Feedback

A one-time setup that tells this device where your detachment keeps its feedback data.

✓ Organization

2 Storage

3 Connect

4 Finish

Where should the database live?

You can change this later in Settings, and export your data first if you do.

☐  **Google Drive (recommended)**
Connects to your detachment's Google account over the Drive API. Works on phones, tablets and computers, and every device sees the same data.

☐  **Synced Drive folder on this computer**
Points at the TOP-Feedback folder inside Google Drive for Desktop. Google's own client handles syncing. Desktop Chrome or Edge only.

☐  **This device only**
Stores everything in this browser. Nothing syncs and nothing is shared. Good for trying the app out before the Google account exists.

Back

Continue

TOP-Feedback — your detachment's data stays in your own Google account.

Step 2 of the wizard. Options unavailable on the current device are greyed out with the reason.

9

TF

TOP-Feedback
Not configured

● setup

Set up TOP-Feedback

A one-time setup that tells this device where your detachment keeps its feedback data.

✓ Organization

✓ Storage

✓ Connect

4 Finish

Ready to build the database

These folders will be created if they do not already exist. Existing data is left untouched, so it is safe to point a second device at the same folder.

TOP-Feedback/
├ config/ org profile, shared settings
├ users/ accounts – students, instructors, admins
├ roster/ legacy student roster (migrated into users/)
├ forms/ feedback form definitions
├ requests/ feedback requests issued to students
├ responses/ submitted feedback, one folder per request
├ receipts/ who submitted (kept apart from what they said)
├ audit/ who deleted or changed what, and when
├ reports/ exported reports (CSV / JSON)
└ archive/ closed terms retained for the record

Organization

Storage

Location

AFROTC Detachment 025
This device only
This device

Back

✓ Create folders and finish

Step 4 shows the folder structure before creating it. Each record is a plain JSON file you can read in Drive.

10

5 Claim the folder

TOP-Feedback issues no passwords. Everyone signs in with the Google account your detachment already mails them at, and a roster inside your Drive folder decides who is allowed in and what they can do. Your first job is to put yourself on that roster.

A folder with an empty roster is claimed by **the first Google account to sign in**, which becomes both a database administrator and an instructor. After that the roster is closed: an account that is not on it is turned away, whoever it belongs to.

1 Confirm the folder is shared with the right people before you start.

Drive sharing is the control that actually matters — see the note below.

2 From the home screen, open *Database Administration*.

It should say this detachment has no roster yet.

3 Click Sign in with Google

and choose the account you want to administer the detachment with.

4 Confirm you landed in the console

and that your email appears on the roster with the *Database admin* and *Instructor* roles.

5 Add a second administrator.

The console will remind you while you are the only one. It is not a formality: a single admin who loses access leaves the roster repairable only by editing `users/users.json` in Drive by hand.

6 Check that development mode is off.

Go to *Settings* → *Access*. It should read "Sign-in is enforced".

Share the folder before the first sign-in, not after

Whoever can reach the app and open the folder can claim an unclaimed one. That is deliberate — it is how a new detachment gets in without a shared password that would be published in a guide like this one. It also means the window between creating the folder and claiming it should be short, and the folder should be shared only with the people who need it.

Development mode

This setting unlocks the Instructor Portal and admin console on one device without signing in. It exists for building and demonstrating the app. It must be off before any cadet can reach the device. The app shows a warning banner on every affected screen while it is on.

6 Build the roster

Everyone signs in — cadets included. That is what makes "one submission per student" mean something rather than relying on an honour system.

ROLE	CAN DO
Student	See feedback assigned to them and submit it once.
Instructor	Create feedback, read responses, run analysis.
Database admin	Add and remove people, maintain the database, delete feedback the safety screen has flagged.

Which email address?

The one your detachment actually mails the cadet at. At a regional detachment that is usually a Gmail address, even for cadets whose school address ends in `.edu` — many colleges run their mail through Google, and the cadet reads it in Gmail. If in doubt, use the address already in your distribution list. It is the address the cadet will click "Sign in with Google" as.

One at a time

- 1 Open Database Administration**
and click *Add person*.
- 2 Enter their name and their Google account email.**
- 3 Tick the roles they need**
and choose their AS level.
- 4 Save.**
There is nothing to hand them — they can sign in immediately.

A whole class at once

- 1 Prepare a CSV**
with a `name` column and an `email` column. An optional `class` column sets their AS level.
- 2 Click Import roster CSV**
and choose the file.

3

Fix anything it could not add.

A duplicate address or a typo is listed with the reason. Correct the file and import again — rows already added are skipped rather than duplicated.

Telling them how to get in

Adding someone to the roster does not notify them — this app sends no mail. Once they are on the list, send them the join link from *Invite people* at the top of this same screen. **Copy link** for chat, **Email it** to open a pre-written message, or **Share** on a phone.

When someone changes email

Edit their account and change the address. Their submission history follows them: receipts are filed under an internal handle such as `alvarez.mia`, which does not change when the email does.

When someone leaves

Untick **Active** rather than deleting them. A deactivated account cannot sign in, but the record stays, so past feedback still makes sense. Deleting is available too, and is recorded in the activity log either way.

There is nothing to reset

If a cadet cannot get in, it is one of three things: the address on the roster is not the one they are signing in with, their account is marked inactive, or they do not have the role for the screen they opened. All three are visible in *Database Administration*. This app has no password to forget.

7 Install on phones and laptops

TOP-Feedback can be added to a home screen so it opens like an ordinary app, works offline, and does not need anyone to remember a web address.

Add the icon first, then run setup inside it

A home-screen app gets its own private storage, separate from the browser it was added from. Configure the app in the browser first and the icon may open to an empty setup wizard, and you will paste the Client ID and folder link a second time. Adding the icon *before* setting anything up means doing it once.

Cadets do not run this wizard — send them a join link

Everything on this page is for *your* device. For everyone else, go to *Database Administration* → *Invite people* and send the join link. It carries the Client ID and the folder, so a cadet taps it, approves Google once, and lands on their feedback. Nothing to paste and nothing to explain.

The link is safe to post wherever your detachment already talks. Everything in it is public or an address, and opening it grants nothing on its own — the roster still decides who may sign in.

DEVICE	HOW
iPhone / iPad	Open the address, tap the Share button, then <i>Add to Home Screen</i> . Safari and Chrome both work; both produce a real full-screen app.
Android	Open in Chrome. Tap the menu, then <i>Install app</i> or <i>Add to Home screen</i> .
Windows / macOS	In Chrome or Edge, click the install icon in the address bar, or use <i>Settings</i> → <i>Access</i> → <i>Install this app</i> inside TOP-Feedback.

What works offline

The app opens and a cadet can fill in a form with no signal. A submission made offline is saved on the device, shown as pending in the header, and sent automatically when the connection returns. Nothing is lost. Reading existing feedback does need a connection.

8 Verify and hand over

Work through this before letting cadets use the app for real.

- ☐ **The app opens over HTTPS** at the address you published.
- ☐ **Settings → Access reads "Sign-in is enforced"** — development mode is off.
- ☐ **At least two people hold the Database admin role**, so losing one account does not lock the detachment out.
- ☐ **The connection indicator in the header reads "ready"** on a device other than the one you set up on.
- ☐ **The Drive folder contains the app's folders** — open it in Drive and confirm you can see `config`, `users`, `forms` and the rest.
- ☐ **A test cadet can sign in with their own Google account** and see feedback assigned to them — on their own phone, not yours.
- ☐ **A test submission appears** in the Instructor Portal under Responses & Analysis.
- ☐ **You have exported a backup** from Instructor Portal → Database → Export backup.
- ☐ **The Drive folder is shared with exactly the people who should read everything in it** — this, not the sign-in screen, is what controls access.

Moving trial data into Drive

If you evaluated using *This device only*:

- 1 On the trial device, go to *Instructor Portal → Database → Export backup* and save the JSON file.
- 2 Go to *Settings → Re-run setup* and connect to Google Drive as in Part 4.
- 3 Return to *Database → Import backup*, choose the file, and select *Merge*.

Routine maintenance

TASK	HOW OFTEN	WHERE
Export a backup	End of each term	Instructor Portal → Database
Review accounts, deactivate leavers	Start of each term	Database Administration
Rebuild indexes (only if counts look wrong)	Rarely	Database Administration

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Could not connect" when signing in to Google	The app's address is not listed under <i>Authorised JavaScript origins</i> . Add it exactly, including <code>https://</code> and with no trailing slash. Wait a few minutes.
Google shows "app is not verified" or blocks sign-in	The OAuth consent screen is set to <i>External</i> and this person is not a test user. Add their Google address under <i>Test users</i> , or switch to <i>Internal</i> if you use Workspace.
The sign-in popup does not open	Popups are blocked for the site. Allow them and try again.
"Access blocked ... has not completed the Google verification process", with no <i>Advanced</i> link	Either the app was published to production, or this account is not a test user. Open the OAuth consent screen: if it says <i>In production</i> , click Back to testing . If it says <i>Testing</i> , add the account under <i>Test users</i> — including the account that owns the project, which is not added automatically.
"Google hasn't verified this app", with an <i>Advanced</i> link	Expected, not an error. Click <i>Advanced</i> , then <i>Go to ... (unsafe)</i> . Unavoidable while the app is in Testing.
Google refuses to add an address as a test user	A Google-side behaviour with no published fix. Check whether the account holds a role under <i>IAM & Admin</i> , whether it is enrolled in Advanced Protection, and try the classic <i>Credentials</i> view. If it still will not take, that person needs a different Google account.
Sign-in popup closes immediately, or <code>origin_mismatch</code>	The address the app is served from is not listed under <i>Authorised JavaScript origins</i> . It must match exactly: scheme included, no path, no trailing slash. Changes can take a few minutes to take effect.
The home-screen icon opens the setup wizard again	Normal. A home-screen app has its own storage, separate from the browser. Run the wizard once inside the icon app and it will not ask again.
Connects, then Drive requests fail with 403	The Google Drive API was never enabled on the project. Part 2, step 2.
"The folder or file was not found"	The folder link is wrong, or the signed-in account does not have access to it. Re-copy the link and confirm sharing.
Header shows "offline" with a pending count	Normal. Work is saved on the device and sends automatically. Click the pending badge to retry now.
A cadet cannot see a form	Check its status is <i>Open</i> , the open date has passed, the due date has not, and the AS level matches theirs. If it targets named students, check they are on the list.

"Results withheld" instead of analysis	Working as designed. Anonymous results stay hidden until three people have responded, because a single response can be traced to its author by elimination.
"Not on this detachment's roster"	The address they signed in with is not the one on the roster. Ask what Google account they used and compare it with Database Administration — a school address and the Gmail account behind it are two different strings.
Nobody can sign in as an administrator	Open <code>users/users.json</code> in Drive, add <code>"admin"</code> to the <code>roles</code> array of an account you control, and save. This is the recovery path; it is why at least two people should hold the admin role.
Response counts look wrong	Database Administration → <i>Rebuild indexes</i> . Counts are a cache and can lag; this rebuilds them from the underlying records.

What this version cannot do yet

This build has been installed and run end to end against real Google Drive, on a Mac and an iPhone. These are its known limits, stated plainly so you can plan around them.

LIMIT	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
100 users maximum	The app must stay in Testing, which caps the test-user list at 100 accounts. Enough for a detachment; not enough for a wing.
Everyone sees an "unverified app" screen	Every user, every time they grant access. Brief people on it so it does not read as a security problem. Removing it requires Google verification and a paid annual security assessment.
Everyone who submits needs Editor access to the folder	A cadet's device writes its own response file directly to Drive, and Drive grants no write-without-read. So anyone who can submit feedback can also open the folder and read every response in it. Do not describe responses as private from other cadets until this changes. Anonymity within the app's own screens is real; the folder is not sealed.
Some Google accounts cannot be added as test users	Cause unknown, Google-side. Those people need a different Google account for now.

Reference

What gets created in your folder

TOP-Feedback/	
├ config/	detachment profile and shared settings
├ users/	the roster – who may sign in, and as what
├ forms/	feedback form definitions
├ requests/	feedback issued to students, each with an ID
├ responses/	submitted feedback, one folder per form
├ receipts/	who submitted (kept apart from what they said)
├ reports/	exported reports
└ archive/	closed terms retained for the record

Things worth understanding before you field this

Anonymity is real, and it has a limit

On an anonymous form the cadet's sign-in is used to verify them and to write a *receipt*, then discarded. The response record carries no name, and receipts live in a different folder. This is what lets the app say "two cadets still owe feedback" about responses nobody can attribute. The limit: with very few responses, a single answer can be identified by elimination, so anonymous results stay hidden until three people have responded.

Sign-in is not encryption

Anyone with access to the Drive folder can read every record directly, regardless of what the app shows them. Folder sharing is the real access control. Share it only with people entitled to read all of it.

The app stores no credentials at all — `users/users.json` holds emails and roles, nothing secret. The identity check is Google's. The app validates the sign-in token in the browser, which catches an expired or misdirected one but is not a defence against someone who controls the browser; Drive's own permission check is.

The safety screen is a prompt, not a finding

Written answers are automatically checked for language about hazing, harassment, discrimination, violence, self-harm, substances and integrity. A match means read that response now — it cannot tell "we discussed hazing prevention" from "I was hazed". A clear screen is not proof that nothing was reported. Follow your detachment's own reporting procedures.

Safety alerts override the anonymity threshold

If a flagged answer appears on a form whose results are otherwise withheld, the app tells you it exists and lets you open it behind a warning that doing so may identify the author. A disclosure cannot wait for a third response to arrive.

Getting help

Diagnostics are available at *Settings* → *Download diagnostics*. The file records the app version, storage configuration and browser, and contains no feedback data — it is safe to share when asking for help.